

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Mozzarella-Stuffed Meatballs

with Garlic Bread and Charred Broccoli

Tonight, we're kicking meatballs up a notch by stuffing them with fresh mozzarella. They're baked until tender, then simmered in tomato sauce until the cheese is perfectly melted. Add homemade garlic bread on the side for scooping up every last drop of sauce, and you've got a saucy, satisfying meal for the books.

45–55 minutes 940 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 2 packets unsalted butter
- 8 ounces broccoli florets
- ¼ ounce parsley, divided
- 4 ounces fresh mozzarella
- 1 red onion
- 3 cloves garlic
- 1 can crushed tomatoes
- ¼ cup panko breadcrumbs
- 1 ounce grated Parmesan cheese, divided
- 12 ounces ground beef, pork, and veal
- 1 ciabatta roll

You'll need

- olive oil
- 1 egg
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 12" large high-sided pan
- aluminum foil
- 2 baking sheets

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Salt breaks down garlic by extracting its natural juices. Scrape and press down repeatedly to create a smooth, flavorful paste for your garlic butter.

Save the remaining mozzarella for another use, like a topping for homemade pizza.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef, pork, and veal to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Place **butter** in a small bowl; set aside to soften at room temperature. Rinse **broccoli** and cut to 1 inch–wide florets, if needed. Rinse **parsley**; finely chop leaves, discarding stems. Cut **half of mozzarella** into ¼-inch cubes. Peel **onion** and cut into small dice. Mince **garlic** and, still on cutting board, sprinkle over **¼ teaspoon salt**. Using a large knife, carefully scrape over mixture at a 45° angle, pressing down (see recipe tip).



2. Sauté aromatics

Transfer **half of garlic paste** to bowl with butter, season with **pepper**, and mash with a fork to combine. Set **garlic butter** aside. Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large high-sided pan over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **onion**. Cook, stirring, until soft, 5 minutes. Add **remaining garlic paste** and cook until fragrant, 1 minute more. Remove pan from heat. Place **half of aromatics** in a large bowl, reserving remainder in pan for the next step.



3. Simmer sauce

Return pan with aromatics to medium heat with **crushed tomatoes** and **¼ teaspoon salt**. Increase heat to high and bring to a boil, then reduce heat to medium and simmer until sauce is thickened, 7–10 minutes. Remove pan from heat. Meanwhile, to bowl with aromatics, add **breadcrumbs**, **1 tablespoon Parmesan**, **half of parsley**, **1 egg**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper**. Line a baking sheet with foil for the next step.



4. Form and bake meatballs

Pat **beef, pork, and veal** dry with paper towel, then add to bowl with breadcrumbs. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 6 equal balls, about 1½ inches thick. Push **mozzarella cubes** into center of each meatball, dividing evenly and pinching to seal in cheese. Arrange **meatballs** on prepared sheet and bake until browned and cooked through, 13–15 minutes. Transfer **baked meatballs** to pan with tomato sauce, still off heat, and stir to coat.



5. Char broccoli and toast ciabatta

While meatballs bake, on a separate baking sheet, toss **broccoli** with **1 tablespoon olive oil**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Arrange in a single layer on 1 half of sheet. Halve **ciabatta roll** lengthwise, if it arrived whole, and arrange cut-side up on other half of sheet. Spread cut sides of **ciabatta** with **garlic butter**, dividing evenly. Bake until broccoli is lightly charred and bread is golden, about 10 minutes.



6. Plate meatballs

Use any downtime while broccoli roasts to set the table. Then, sprinkle **1 tablespoon Parmesan** over **roasted broccoli** on baking sheet, toss to combine, and transfer to serving plates, along with **mozzarella-stuffed meatballs**. Garnish with **remaining parsley** and **remaining Parmesan**, serve with **garlic bread**, and dig in!

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